

# Guide Whisper for transcription

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# 1. Introduction



This guide provides step-by-step instructions for using Whisper to automatically transcribe audio recordings in the laboratory.

It is intended for researchers and laboratory staff who need to process interview recordings efficiently and obtain a first transcription that can subsequently be reviewed and corrected.

The guide covers the complete transcription workflow, from preparing the project and audio files to launching the transcription, monitoring its progress, and retrieving the final transcript.

 **Whisper is available at the laboratory — Room A4.340**

*Important: Whisper generates an automatic transcription. The resulting text should always be reviewed and corrected before being used for research purposes.*

## 2. Using Whisper in the Laboratory

### 2.1 Overview of the Workflow

The transcription process follows these main steps:

#### **01 — Prepare your workspace**

Organize the project folder and audio files.

#### **02 — Configure the script**

Specify the project folder and check the required parameters.

#### **03 — Run the script**

Launch the transcription process.

#### **04 — Monitor the process**

Check that the transcription is progressing correctly.

#### **05 — Retrieve the transcription**

Locate and save the generated transcription files.

### 2.2 Preparing Audio Files

The quality of the transcription depends partly on the quality of the original recording.

#### **Whenever possible:**

- use good-quality audio recordings;
- minimize background noise;
- avoid unnecessary audio compression;
- make sure that speakers can be heard clearly.

## 2. Using Whisper in the Laboratory

### 2.3 Step-by-Step Usage Guide

#### 2.3.1 Preparing Your Workspace

Before launching Whisper, make sure that your project is properly organized.

Create a dedicated folder for each project and place the audio recordings that need to be transcribed inside the appropriate folder.

Before starting, check that:

- The project folder has the correct name.
- The audio files are stored in the correct location.
- The audio files are in the required format.
- The files are accessible from the computer running the script.
- No unnecessary files have been added to the transcription folder.

#### 2.3.2 Running the Script

Once the workspace is prepared, open the Whisper transcription script. The script is used to automatically process the audio recordings and generate the corresponding transcripts.

Before running it, check that the parameters correspond to the project you want to process.

*Tip: Do not modify parameters that are not mentioned in this guide unless you know what they control.*

## 2. Using Whisper in the Laboratory

### 2.3 Step-by-Step Usage Guide

#### 2.3.3 Editing the Script

**Some information must be adapted before running the script for a new project.**

#### **Project folder name**

The project folder must be correctly specified in the script.

Replace the existing project name with the name of the folder you want to transcribe.

*Example: Project\_01 → Project\_02*

*Make sure that the folder name exactly matches the name of the folder on your computer.*

#### **Audio file format**

Check that the audio files are saved in the format supported by the script. If your recordings are in another format, they may need to be converted before running the transcription.

*Example: .wav*

# PHOTOS

## 2. Using Whisper in the Laboratory

### 2.3 Step-by-Step Usage Guide

#### 2.3.4 Launching the Transcription

Once the project folder and parameters have been checked, the transcription can be launched.

**Step 1:** Open the terminal / command prompt used to run the script.

**Step 2:** Navigate to the folder containing the Whisper script.

**Step 3:** Run the transcription command.

**Step 4:** Wait for the transcription process to start.

- Once Whisper starts processing the audio file, information about the transcription should appear in the terminal.

***Do not close the terminal while the transcription is running.***

## 2. Using Whisper in the Laboratory

### 2.3 Step-by-Step Usage Guide

#### 2.3.5 Monitoring the Transcription Progress

The transcription process may take some time depending on:

- the duration of the recording,
- the number of audio files,
- the computer's processing capacity,
- and the Whisper model being used.

While the transcription is running, check the terminal to make sure that the process is progressing normally. If several recordings belong to the same project, they can be placed in the same audio folder and processed.

#### **If the process appears to be stuck:**

- Wait a few minutes to make sure the process is not simply taking longer than expected.
- Check whether the terminal displays an error message.
- Check that the audio file can be opened normally.
- Verify that the project folder and file path are correct.

## 2. Using Whisper in the Laboratory

### 2.3 Step-by-Step Usage Guide

#### 2.3.6 Retrieving the Transcription

Once the transcription is complete, the generated files can be retrieved from the output folder, open the project folder and locate the folder containing the generated transcripts.

After transcription:

- ✓ Check that the file has been generated.
- ✓ Open the file and verify that the text is readable.
- ✓ Check the beginning and end of the transcript.
- ✓ Rename or organize the file if necessary.

*Important: Automatic transcription should always be manually reviewed. Whisper may incorrectly transcribe names, technical terms, abbreviations, or parts of conversations affected by background noise or overlapping speech.*

### 3. Managing Multiple Projects

When working with several projects, it is important to maintain a consistent folder structure. Each project should have its own dedicated folder containing the corresponding audio recordings and transcripts.

Recommended structure:

#### **Project 01**

(image dossier) Audio

(image dossier) Transcriptions

#### **Project 02**

→ Audio

→ Transcriptions

#### **Project 03**

→ Audio

→ Transcriptions

This organization helps prevent files from different projects from being mixed up.

Before starting a batch transcription, check:

- that all files belong to the same project;
- that the files have the correct format;
- that the files are correctly named;
- that there are no duplicate recordings.

## 4. Finally

Whisper provides an automatic transcription, not a final validated transcript. A manual review is therefore highly recommended.

### **Pay particular attention to:**

- participant names;
- medical or scientific terminology;
- abbreviations;
- numbers and dates;
- unclear sentences;
- overlapping speech;
- background noise;
- changes of speaker.

The level of correction required may vary depending on the quality of the recording.

It's your turn !